ACTIVE RECONNAISSANCE

TryHackMe Learning & Practical Report

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Focus: Web Application Security / WAPT Foundations

Platform: TryHackMe

Room: Active Reconnaissance

IqraSec Academy - WAPT Internship - Phase 1

1. Executive Summary

In this room I moved from passive to active recon: using the browser and Developer Tools, ping, traceroute and telnet to talk to a target directly and learn about it.

2. Lab Information

Platform	TryHackMe
Room / Lab	Active Reconnaissance
Primary Domain	Web Application Security
Purpose	Foundational WAPT practice
Completion	Completed - all room tasks finished
Link	https://tryhackme.com/room/activerecon

3. Learning Objectives

- Understand why active recon can be detected.
- Use the browser and Developer Tools to inspect a website.
- Use ping and traceroute to check reachability and path.
- Use telnet to connect to a service and read its banner.

4. Web Browser and Developer Tools

I opened the room web page and used Developer Tools to read the source and the JavaScript files, and to count the questions on the page. The Network and Sources tabs show everything the browser loads.

5. Ping

I read the manual page of ping and then pinged an IP. The result was "Destination Host Unreachable" with 100% packet loss, which means the host was down, not reachable or blocking ICMP.

6. Traceroute

Traceroute shows every router (hop) between me and the target. I used it to find the last hop IP before tryhackme.com and the number of routers between two systems, and ran it against the lab machine.

7. Telnet

I connected with telnet <IP> 80 to the lab machine, typed GET / HTTP/1.1 and Host: telnet and pressed Enter twice. The server answered with its headers, which showed it was Apache 2.4.61 on Debian. This is called banner grabbing.

8. Evidence

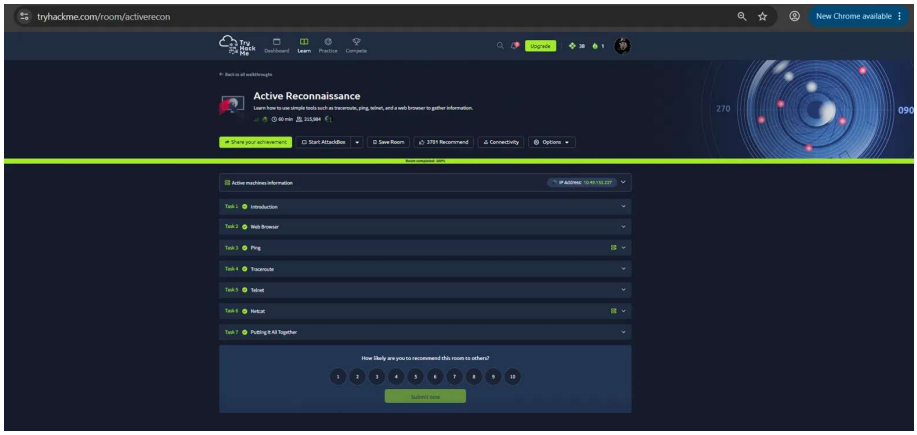


Fig 1 - Room overview.

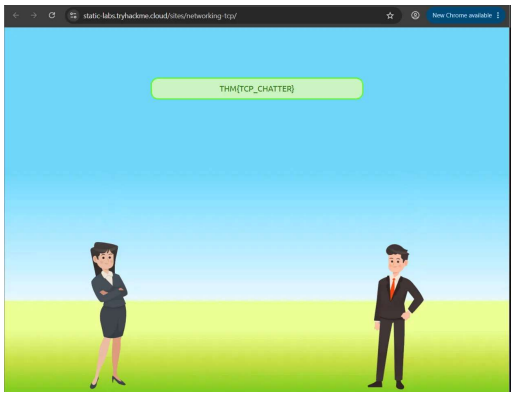


Fig 2 - Practice website opened in the browser.

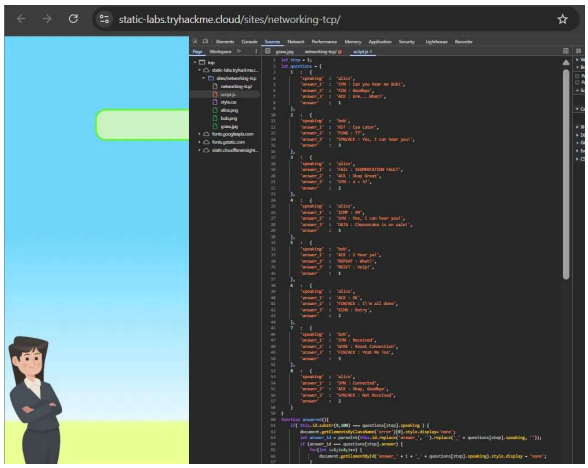


Fig 3 - Developer Tools showing the page source.

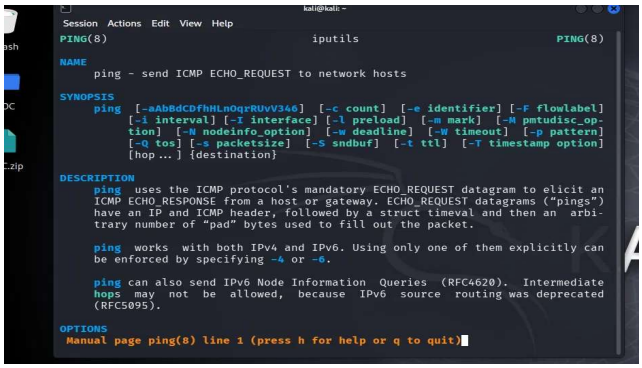


Fig 4 - ping manual page.

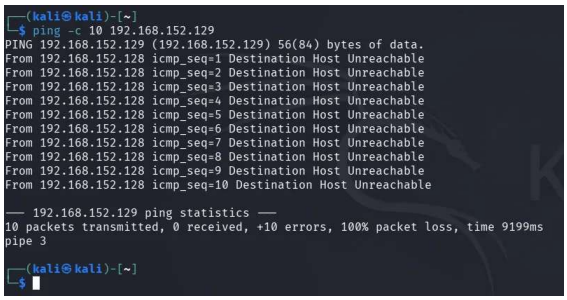


Fig 5 - ping result: Destination Host Unreachable.

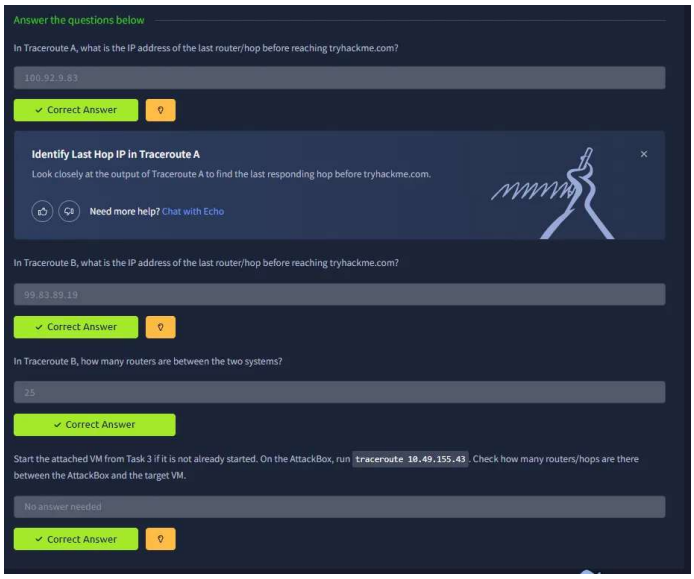


Fig 6 - traceroute questions answered.

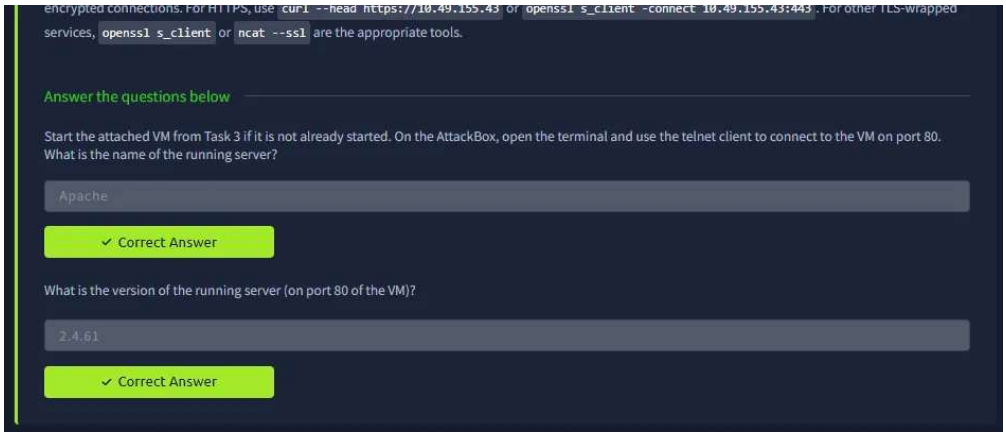


Fig 7 - telnet questions: server name and version.

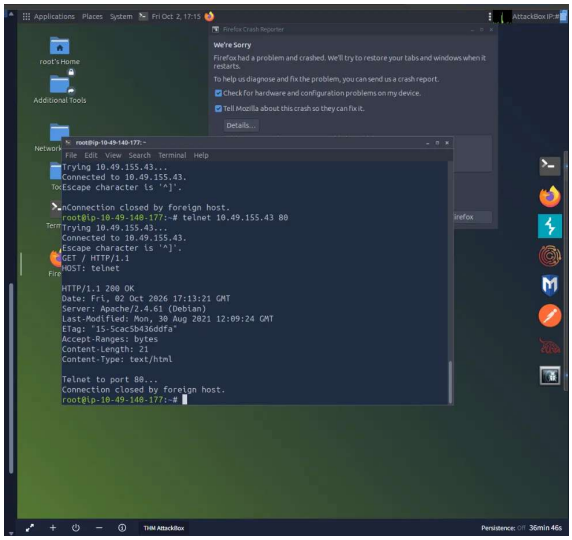


Fig 8 - telnet to port 80 and the HTTP response.

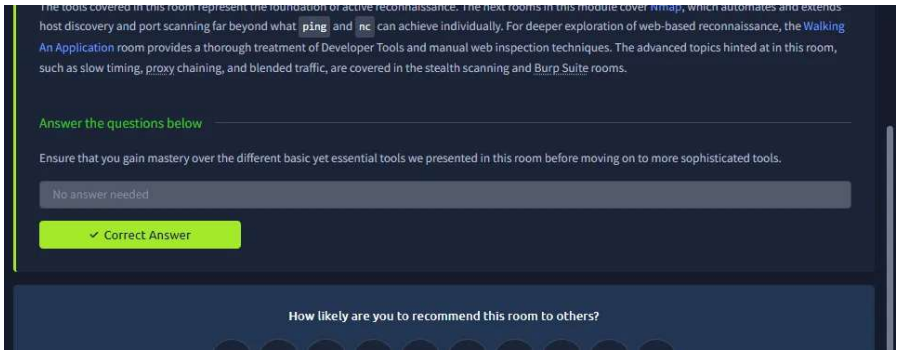


Fig 9 - Room completed.

9. Key Security Takeaways

- Active recon sends traffic to the target, so I need permission and my scans can appear in logs.
- Banners reveal software and version, which helps an attacker find known vulnerabilities.
- Hiding or reducing version information is a simple hardening step.

A failed ping does not always mean the host is down; ICMP may be blocked.

10. Skills Practiced

Area	**Practical understanding gained**
Browser tools	Developer Tools, source and network inspection
ICMP	ping and reading results
Path discovery	traceroute and hops
Banner grabbing	telnet to port 80

11. What I Would Explore Next

I will learn nmap for automated port and service scanning, and then use it together with Burp Suite.

12. Conclusion

Active recon gave me hands-on practice with simple tools that every tester uses. I learned what each one shows and how a banner can leak the exact version of a server.

Completion status: Completed - all room tasks finished.

13. References

TryHackMe: https://tryhackme.com/room/activerecon